

God's Design for Sex

Transcript of the God's Design podcast episode

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Good day and welcome to this podcast. I'm your host Ashton. Today we're going to continue with a series called God's Design. If you haven't checked out the first two installments then I strongly suggest you go and check it out so that you can get up to speed with what we are talking about. This podcast is a response to the onslaught that is taking place against our young people about sex and the secular view of sex. If we as the church allow the secular views to continue to permeate the minds of our youth then we will have a pandemic of a different sort within the church.

So this teaching is for any pastor, youth leader or any Christian who wants to have a discussion about sex with the youth then they have material on which they can fall back on. In this podcast we will also look at scriptures that support God's view of sex and how we should conduct ourselves as Christians. As the church and as parents it is our responsibility to educate our kids about sex. We must educate our kids on God's plan for their sexuality since God created us and also the proper use of our bodies with regards to sex.

Children as they grow will start to find out about sex. There are many sources for them to find out and if we don't teach them then they may be wrongly influenced by secular media or friends or even sexual groomers and also by the culture in which they grow up in. It is our responsibility to lay down the foundation for them before someone else does. Friends alone unfortunately are just not the best influences for our children and can normalize perversion in your child.

So your child will see perverted views on sex as normal if the issue is not addressed. The wrong messages sent will distort your child's view on sex and about their bodies. In many cultures sex was a very taboo subject and was not discussed with children and most of the time regardless of your location on earth. If you even mention sex when you were a child your parents may threaten you with a hiding. So it was very difficult for children to approach their parents on that subject.

But the talk is a powerful tool in the hand of the church and of the parents to educate our kids on God's design for their bodies. Parents should engage the child or children in the subject of sex and be open to the child or children of a reasonable age of understanding to have that kind of dialogue. And as a parent if you require assistance then reach out to a pastor or somebody in that field that can assist you with having that particular talk. There are three aspects to sex.

There is the physical, the emotional and the spiritual aspect. There are three aspects to the child's view on the subject. It is important to start with the spiritual because it will deal with the creator's views first. His original intent was that by keeping yourself from defilement, you will produce a lot of healthy emotions that your partner will benefit from and you from them. Unfortunately, purity is a very rare commodity these days. One of the subjects that is going to be raised when speaking with the youth is the subject of masturbation.

Pleasuring yourself until you reach an orgasm. Typically only thought of as something that boys would do, but girls also do this. Many kids and adults become hooked on masturbation. In adults, married adults, it's a form of rejection against their partner. Masturbation doesn't go away in marriage and I think that's one of the most common misconceptions about masturbation. If masturbation is practiced regularly as a young person, then the habit and the action of it will remain with you until true repentance takes place.

Apart from the doors that it opens in your life in the realm of the spirit, if the habit, which has become an addiction, because masturbation ultimately becomes an addiction, it makes your partner question your love for them. Because in marriage you are one flesh and masturbation, apart from it being idolatry, is also very selfish. It's your own way over God's way. Masturbation will awaken feelings inside of you that should truly be awoken within a marriage.

One of the feelings masturbation has, if you get caught you feel guilt or shame. This particular guilt and shame comes from being caught operating outside of the design of God. Adam and Eve hid. They felt guilt when God was in the garden and they were ashamed. The same feelings that masturbation produces. Men and women who are married hide this practice from their partner, as they don't want their partner to know what they are doing. Another topic that needs to be addressed is that of pornography.

Pornography is just another addiction, another sexual addiction men and women struggle with. It robs the person who watches it in the true knowing and encounter of their partner. A person who is influenced by pornography will demand sex according to what they have witnessed. While watching pornography. Pornography is just acting and I think that's what

children need to understand. It's fantasy. Those people get paid. Some of them are models. Some of them are in big problems.

That's why they are doing pornography for cash. Pornography only sells you fakeness. It sells you fantasy. It sells you problems. Yes, it's true they are engaging in the acts of sex. But it may take the whole day of shooting that particular scene to get the proper look of that scene. To get that fetish that they want to sell to you. So it's not just happening in that 5 or 6 or 10 minute video clip that you... But God requires us to know our partners, not spring surprises on them that is outside of the design of God in bed.

The word know means to intimately know the limits of your partner, the likes of your partner, and to operate within the godly design that God has for you and your partner. You will not harm your partner, you will not hurt your partner, you will not make your partner feel inadequate because you know them intimately. A person who watches porn will ultimately have unrealistic expectations from their partner and soon find out that when their needs are not met in the marriage or with their partner, then they feel unfulfilled.

Pornography can make you reclusive. It can reinforce your own inadequacies about your appearance. It can create within you a preference and false expectation from people. These expectations may make it seem like what you see on the video you're watching is actually normal in everybody's bedroom, and that's not the case. Ultimately, what you see in you, you're going to reap later on in life, and your relationships will pay the price for your ungodly expectations.

So now we're going to look at scriptures and just see how far God wants us to actually go. For this is the will of God, that you should be consecrated, which means separated and set apart for pure and holy living, that you should abstain and shrink from all fornication. The word fornication in the Greek is *ponia*, pornography, where we get our word pornography from. That each one of you should know how to possess, and in the Amplified Version it has there, to control, to control, manage, his own body in consecration.

There is purity separated from the things profane and honor. Verse 5 says, Not to be used in the passion of lust, concupiscence, like the heathen who are ignorant of the true God and have no knowledge of his will. I like the fact that Paul believes that there is such a practice that is occurring currently in the world. He says, Like the heathen do. So there is a godly design, and there is an ungodly design, and Paul is saying we should not follow the pattern of the ungodly design, because they do not know the true God, or God's will, or have knowledge of him.

Colossians 3, verses 4 and 5 says, When Christ, who is our life, appears, then you also will appear with him, and in brackets it says, the splendor of his glory. So kill, and it says in the brackets they didn't deprive the power, the evil desire lurking within your members, those animal impulses, and all that is earthly in you that is employed in sin. I like that. Because it says it is employed in sin, and when you employ your members in sin, the wages of sin is death.

It goes on to say fornication, impurity, sensual appetites, unholy desires, and greed, and covetousness, for that is idolatry, the define of self and other created things instead of God. So we can see from these verses, God is saying some things. Number one is having sex when you are not married. What is the meaning of fornication? It's sexual intercourse between a man and a woman who are not married, or any form of sexual behavior considered to be immoral.

Fornication in the Greek, the word is pornia, meaning pornography, to indulge unlawfully outside of a limit that has been set by God. Idolatry, harlotry, fornication are the root words. The root words for it is pornia. Galatians 5 verse 19 to 21 says, Now the doings, the practices of the flesh are clear, obvious. They are immorality, impurity, indecency. Verse 20 says, Verse 21 says, And this means to put something before God, substitute for God, substituting the real activity or thing.

An idol is not God. It is something in a person's mind that looks like God. The next one is harlotry. Ezekiel chapter 23 verse 8 says, Neither has she left her harlotries since the days of Egypt, from where she brought them. For in her youth men lay there with her, and handled her girlish bosoms. And they were poured out their sinful desire upon her. The last part says, And they poured out their sinful desire upon her. Ezekiel 23 verse 3 says, And they played the harlots in Egypt.

And they played the harlots with their youth. And their bosoms were pressed. And their virgin breasts were handled. The definition is, Involved in activity outside of God's limits. Young girls should take very note of this. Adultery is the next one. The Greek word has the same root, meaning mine. Showing ownership. The definitions to set your affections, romantic gift or ability, On that which is not yours, Or that which you do not belong to. James 4 verse 4 says, You are like unfaithful wives, Having illicit love affairs with the world, And breaking your marriage vow to God.

Do you not know that being the world's friend, Is being God's enemy? So whoever chooses to be a friend of the world, Takes his stand as the end. Enemy or an enemy of God. So the question is, does your hope and attraction lie more towards what is godly or more towards what is worldly? That is a self-examination you will have to do within yourself. It is natural

for young people to be attracted to one another. That's quite normal. That is how the chemistry between two people start.

The point we are trying to make is that when the attraction, that chemistry is there, how far can you go? 1 Samuel 16 verse 7 says, For the Lord sees not as man sees. For man looks on the outward appearance, but the Lord looks on the heart. Of course God gave us feelings and he wants us to be in love with our spouses, but the enemy wants to make that love very cheap. Every time you give your heart to someone and it gets broken, you have less to give to your spouse someday.

This is called fragmentation. Another excuse young people like to use is that everyone is doing it, so surely they can do it also. But just as we read, friendship with the world is enmity with God. You have gone to something, the world to which you do not belong to. You shouldn't be in that particular space. As we read in 1 Thessalonians 4 verses 3 to 7, it is God's will that you should be sanctified, that you are set apart, you are holy, and you should avoid sexual immorality.

Learn to control your own body in a way that is holy and honourable and not lustful. If you reject this instruction, you reject God who gives you the Holy Spirit. Every Christian must count the cost of following Christ and not take being a Christian lightly. So, there should be no sex before marriage. This is the design of God. The next question the youth might ask is, what about heavy petting? Some places they call it dry humping, other places have different names for it, and also oral sex.

And they may reason and say, but that is not sex. Let's look at the meaning of a few difficult words spoken in the Bible, and the meaning. The first being lasciviousness, and the other one is licentiousness. Jude chapter 4. For there are certain men, kept in unawares, who were before of old ordained to this condemnation, ungodly men, turning the grace of our God into lasciviousness, and denying the only Lord God and our Lord Jesus Christ. The definition says, stirring up desires which cannot be satisfied within God's limits.

Excess or too much, going beyond, having no limits or boundaries, letting yourself go. Next word is concupiscence and covetousness. Romans 7 verse 8 says, But sin, taking occasion by the commandment, wrought in me all manner of concupiscence. For without the law, sin was dead. And Colossians chapter 3 verse 5 says, Mortify therefore your members which are upon the earth, fornication, uncleanness, inordinate affection, evil concupiscence, and covetousness, which is idolatry. 1 Thessalonians 4 verses 3 and 5 says, For this is the will of God, even your sanctification, that he should abstain from fornication, that every one of you should know

how to possess his vessel in sanctification and honor, not in the lust of concupiscence, even as the Gentiles which know not God.

The definition, therefore, of these words is having an abnormally strong desire or appetite in the area of sexuality. If you have a situation where you cannot control your thinking or something keeps coming up, if you're hung up on or preoccupied by guys or girls, need to have a boyfriend or a girlfriend as a matter of urgency, this all falls into lust, concupiscence, strong desire that's gotten behind your control. So now we see the root of the matter.

We need to desire after God and that should be our root, our desire, our passion should be for God and God only. We also look at sensuality. 2 Corinthians 12 verse 21 says, And lest, when I come again, my God will humble me among you, and that I shall bewail many which have sinned already, that word bewail means mourn, and have not repented of the uncleanness and fornication and lasciviousness which they have committed. James 3 verse 15 says, This wisdom descended not from above, but is earthly, sensual, and devilish.

Jude 19 reads, These be they who separate themselves, sensual, having not the spirit. 1 Peter verse 2 verse 11 says, Beloved, I implore you as aliens and strangers and exiles in this world to abstain from the sensual urges, the evil desires, the passions of your flesh, your lower nature, that wage war against the soul. The definition given says, The planned appeal to your physical senses or selfish gratification or occupation with bodily sexual pleasure, and that also extends into the realm of flirting.

Pleasure should never be a reason or motivation for living. To live for your physical senses, that is, your drugs, the sex, the music, dance, heavy petting, and for feeling. As we look further, we also see it's defrauding. Leviticus 19 verse 13 says, And Colossians 2 verse 17 to 19 says, Such things are only the shadow of the things that are to come, and they have only symbolic value. But the reality, the substance, the solid fact of what is foreshadowed, the body of it, belongs to Christ.

Let no one defraud you by acting as an umpire and declaring you unworthy and disqualifying you for the prize. Insisting on self-abasement and worship of angels, taking his stand on visions, he claims, he has seen. Vainly puffed up by his sensuous notions and inflated by his unspiritual thoughts and fleshly conceit. And do not hold fast to the head. From whom the entire body, supplied and knit together by means of its joints and ligaments, grows with the growth that is from God.

Definition, to use, take advantage of, to deceive. If you do not have the intention to have a long-term relationship with someone. Also, using other persons for your selfish ends. Not being open and honest about your intentions. So, what are the limits? Young people might

argue, point just before, they might say, penetration is not necessary to orgasm, so can they do that? The answer is, no, you can't. You cannot control yourself, if that's the case, so it's wrong.

They might say, making love, like, to the point of orgasm, but they've got their clothes on, so it's like dry humping. That is still wrong. The next one is, nakedness and petting, to the point of orgasm. That is also masturbation, that is wrong. Your body is to be viewed as by one person and one flesh. So, you're supposed to be in a union with a person. The next point is, just with underwear on, there's a slight difference. Then you tell them, no, that is still wrong.

You are supposed to be holy and set apart for God. And then, again, they may bring up, okay, what if they have got all their clothes on? And then you say, your body, it's still wrong. Your body is meant for your husband to touch and for your wife to touch only. That is God's design. And the young people might ask just about touching and stuff. As it was addressed, you've got to have control. But when you look at what God says about handling a woman's breast, he doesn't take it lightly.

He equals these actions to a harlot. And we know a harlot is a prostitute. Of course, we get that in Ezekiel 23, verse 3. Whenever God gives you an image of something negative, understand God does not approve of that image or action outside of his design. So, we're going to ruffle a little bit more feathers as we're going along in this podcast. Song of Solomon, chapter 4, verse 11 says, Your lips, O my promised bride, drop honey as the honeycomb. Honey and milk are under your tongue.

God sees French kissing as part of foreplay. It causes desires and longing in you for something more. It breaks down your defenses. It is God's will that we are to be sanctified, controlling our own bodies. We were made to have sex, so now the core of our being needs to submit under our will. But the fact that we are sexually right does not mean we should be unholy or sexually immoral. So, in closing, we come to the bottom line. Galatians 5, verse 18 to 21 says, But if you are guided, you are led by the Holy Spirit, you are not subject to the law.

Now the doings, the practices of the flesh are clear. They are obvious. That's not a good thing. Now the things of Bloods are we are not subject to their rules. They are immorality, uncleanness or uncleanliness, impurity, lasciviousness, that is, indecency, idolatry, sorcery, enmity, strife, jealousy, anger, ill-tempered, selfishness, divisions, dissensions, party spirits. Verse 21 says, envy, drunkenness, carousing, that's been having a party, and the like.

I warned you beforehand, just as I did previously, that those who do such things shall not inherit the kingdom of God. Very stern warning. So uncleanness or uncleanness is contamination, pollution and impurity. The opposite of purity, lasciviousness is showing a desire for the unseemingly interest in sex, provoking or inciting lust. 1 Peter 2 verse 9 to 11

says, Beloved, I implore you, as strangers and exiles in this world, to abstain from sensual urges, that is, the evil desires, the passions of the flesh, your lower nature, that wage war against your soul.

As young people, if what you are doing is even bringing up a thought of impurity in your mind, you should abstain and flee from it. You must decide where you must decide where you can draw the line based upon God's principles. If you are stimulated sexually without being able to go through with it, which you are not able to, then it's sin. So in closing, if any relationship causes you to lose faith in God, it's not from God, run away from it. So in closing, again, if you cleanse yourself from your youthful lusts and flee from them, you will be a vessel set apart for honorable and noble purposes.

The choice is yours. You can be a vessel of gold or silver, used for honorable and noble purposes, or a utensil of wood and earthenware, used for menial, unskilled, boring, basic, and dishonorable uses. So if you've already made the mistake, or if the youth have already made the mistake, then you need to remind them that God promises that he will restore the years that the locusts have eaten. He's just looking for a willing, remorseful heart and for the people who will take the stand against the immorality that is in this world.

Someone who will choose to go against the stream and walk in purity. Who will shun youthful lusts and flee from them and cleanse himself or herself from what is unclean. Who separates themselves from anything that's going to contaminate or corrupt or influence them in an ungodly way. So it is up to us to choose God's way over our own way. Because ultimately, God's way is a rewarding journey. God bless you all.